

21 March 2024

Stefano Merlin
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Dear Stefano Merlin

Project 3304: Response to exemption submitted on 27 February 2024

Verra grants an exemption to Project 3304 from the effective date (01 Jan 2024) of version 4.2 of the *AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool*. Please note, this exemption applies to sections 3.2.10 and 3.2.11 of the *VCS Standard, v4.5*, and is only applicable validation of this project.

Next steps

- The project may apply the *AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool, v4.0* for validation of this project.
- The project must upgrade to the *AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool, v4.2*, and comply with sections 3.2.10 and 3.2.11 for the next verification.

Exemptions are granted by Verra on a case-by-case basis and do not form the basis of, or set a precedent for, future exemption request approvals or denials. This letter will be uploaded to the Verra Registry as a public document.

Background

The VCS program update released on 29 August 2023, specifies that all registration requests submitted to Verra on or after 1 Jan 2024 must apply version 4.2 of the *AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool*. Project 3304 initiated validation before the release of the update and is now at the final stage of validation. It has been determined that enforcing compliance would be overly burdensome, impossible, or detrimental to the viability of Project 3304.

Please be advised that where the *AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool, v4.0*, is applied, credits issued will not be eligible for the ICVCM Core Carbon Principles (CCP) label.

Sincerely,

Ciara McCarthy
Director, Natural Climate Solutions
Verra